



LIVING IN SPACE

Space stations are designed to be lived in by teams of astronauts for months at a time while they conduct scientific tests. The first, *Salyut 1*, was launched by the USSR in 1971, followed by the US's *Skylab* in 1973. In 1998, the two countries, along with others, came together to build the International Space Station (ISS) pictured here. The ISS can hold a crew of up to six people at a time and is used to study the effects of living in space on plants, animals, and humans.

YURI GAGARIN

Russian pilot Yuri Gagarin (1934–1968) was the first person to travel into space. On April 12, 1961, he orbited Earth in a capsule called *Vostok 1*, kick-starting the era of human spaceflight. Gagarin became a huge celebrity in Russia and around the world, and his home town was renamed in his honor.



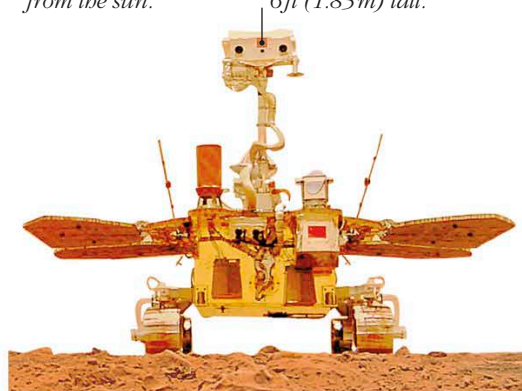
BEYOND THE SOLAR SYSTEM

Launched in 1977, NASA's twin spacecraft *Voyagers 1* and *2* have journeyed beyond the solar system and are still operating today, sending valuable data about the interstellar universe to Earth. Space telescopes, such as the *Hubble* (left) and soon the *James Webb*, observe the deepest reaches of space, and provide incredible images of galaxies and other stellar objects.



The 25-ft- (7.6-m-) long solar panels generate power from the sun.

China's first rover on Mars, *Zhurong*, stands 6ft (1.85m) tall.



UNCREWED MISSIONS

Several uncrewed spacecraft have been sent to explore the solar system in detail. The first, the Russian craft *Venera 1*, flew past Venus in 1961, and since then many have landed on Venus, Mars, and Titan (Saturn's largest moon). The data from the voyages tells us what these objects are made of, their surface, and their atmospheres.

1990

The Hubble Space Telescope becomes the first major telescope to be placed in space.

2012



VOYAGER 1

Voyager 1 becomes the first human-made object to leave the solar system and travel into interstellar space—the space between stars.

2019

China's *Chang'e 4* rover (robotic vehicle) makes the first successful landing on the far side of the moon.

2021

A robotic helicopter called *Ingenuity*—part of NASA's *Perseverance* mission to Mars—achieves the first ever powered flight on another planet.